

Ross Dahlke



Assistant Professor, School of Journalism and Mass Communication, University of Wisconsin–Madison

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Education

Stanford University

PhD, Communication

Palo Alto, CA

2022–2024

- Dissertation: *The Public Sphere in Private Spaces: Politics, News, and Misinformation in Personal Messaging Applications*
- Committee: Jeffrey T. Hancock (Advisor, Communication), Jennifer Pan (Communication), Byron Reeves (Communication), Matthew Gentzkow (Economics), Michael Bernstein (Chair, Computer Science)
- Stanford Data Science Scholar 2023–2024
- Knight-Hennessy Scholar 2022–2023

Stanford University

MA, Communication

Palo Alto, CA

2020–2022

- Knight-Hennessy Scholar 2020–2022

University of Wisconsin–Madison

JBA, Comprehensive Honors (Honors in the Liberal Arts and Honors in the Major), Journalism & Mass Communication and Political Science

Madison, WI

2014–2018

Academic Appointments

Assistant Professor

School of Journalism and Mass Communication · University of Wisconsin–Madison

Madison, WI

2025–Present

- Affiliate, Data Science Institute 2026–Present
- Affiliate, Elections Research Center 2025–Present

Honors & Awards

Top Paper Award, Information Systems Division

International Communication Association Conference

2026

Best Paper Honorable Mention (top ~5% of submissions)

ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems

2026

Top Student Paper Award, Political Communication Division

International Communication Association Conference

2024

Top Reviewer Award, 2023

Social Science Computer Review

2024

Theodore Herfurth Award

University of Wisconsin–Madison · top undergraduate male student in the university

2018

College of Letters and Science Dean's Prize

University of Wisconsin–Madison · top three students in the college

2018

James L. Baughman Senior Achievement Award

University of Wisconsin–Madison · top five students in the School of Journalism and Mass Communication

2018

Research

Publications

Bold = Dahlke · * equal or co-first authorship. Co-author status at time of submission: # graduate-student or postdoctoral · ‡ undergraduate · ^ untenured junior-faculty · + tenured-faculty. All listed articles are peer-reviewed.

17. **Dahlke, R.**, Mine, N.[#], Zhao, H.[#], Huang, Y.[#], & Shah, D.⁺ (2026). Electoral predictions on Polymarket: A quantitative description of trading, commenting, and reacting. *Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media*, 6. <https://doi.org/10.51685/jqd.2026.011>
Coverage · The Washington Post
16. **Dahlke, R.**, Moore, R. C.[#], Adib-Azpeitia, D.[‡], Ugander, J.[^], & Hancock, J. T.⁺ (2026). Multi-platform referrers of misinformation: A comparative analysis of misinformation visits referred by Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, Reddit, YouTube, Snapchat, and TikTok. *Political Communication*. <https://doi.org/10.1080/10584609.2026.2679492>
15. **Dahlke, R.**, Yang, Y.[^], Lukito, J.[^], Greenfield, J.[#], Chen, B.[#], Brown, M. A.[#], & Lewis, R.[#] (2026). Style and substance on The Alex Jones Show predict InfoWars sales: A multi-modal analysis of a media empire. *Information, Communication & Society*, 1–20. <https://doi.org/10.1080/1369118X.2026.2642851>
14. **Dahlke*, R.**, Moore*, R. C.[#], Bengani, P., & Hancock, J. T.⁺ (2026). The consumption of pink slime journalism: Who, what, when, where, and why? *Digital Journalism*, 1–23. <https://doi.org/10.1080/21670811.2026.2669525>
Award · Top Student Paper Award, Political Communication Division of the International Communication Association 2024 Conference
Coverage · Northwestern Local News Initiative, The Boston Globe
13. Kim, Y. M.⁺, **Dahlke, R.**, Song, H.[^], & Heinrich, R. (2026). Targeted digital voter suppression efforts likely decrease voter turnout. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 123(5), e2519944123. <https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2519944123>
12. Lee, A. Y.[#], Stevic, A.[#], Walker-Keleher, G.[‡], Chen, C.[‡], Charity, E.[‡], **Dahlke, R.**, & Hancock, J.⁺ (2026). Going light: The effects of minimal mobile phone adoption on young adults' well-being depend on motivation. *Proceedings of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3772318.3791723>
Award · Best Paper Honorable Mention (top ~5% of submissions), ACM CHI 2026
Coverage · The New York Times, CNBC
11. Lukito, J.[^], Zhang, Y.[^], Pruden, M.[^], Prochaska, S.[#], Chen, B.[^], Zhong, W.[^], Brown, M.[#], **Dahlke, R.**, Suk, J.[^], Greenfield, J.[#], & Borah, P.⁺ (2026). Cross-platformization: How U.S. right-leaning media curate their posts on Twitter and Truth Social. *New Media & Society*. Forthcoming.
10. **Dahlke*, R.**, Tu*, F.[#], Wang*, Y.-C.[#], Lu, Y.[^], Engeda, B. W.[‡], & Hancock, J. T.⁺ (2025). Contextualizing misinformation: A user-centric approach to linguistic and topical patterns in news consumption. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (PACM HCI)*, 9(CSCW1), 1–40. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3757571>
Note · PACM HCI is a peer-reviewed journal (ACM CSCW track).
9. **Dahlke, R.**, & Hancock, J.⁺ (2025). Untrustworthy website exposure and election beliefs: Selective exposure and ideological asymmetry. *Journal of Online Trust and Safety*, 3(1). <https://doi.org/10.54501/jots.v3i1.250>

8. **Dahlke, R.**, Kumar, D.[#], Durumeric, Z.[^], & Hancock, J. T.⁺ (2025). Quantifying the systematic bias in the accessibility and inaccessibility of web scraping content from URL-logged web-browsing digital trace data. *Social Science Computer Review*, 43(5), 1071–1086. <https://doi.org/10.1177/08944393231218214>
7. Lukito, J.[^], Macdonald, M.[^], Chen, B.[#], Brown, M. A.[#], Prochaska, S.[#], Yang, Y.[^], Greenfield, J.[#], Suk, J.[^], Zhong, W.[#], **Dahlke, R.**, & Borah, P.⁺ (2025). Candidates be posting: Multi-platform strategies and partisan preferences in the 2022 US midterm elections. *Social Media+ Society*, 11(2), 20563051251337541. <https://doi.org/10.1177/20563051251337541>
6. **Dahlke, R.**, & Pan, J.⁺ (2024). January 6 arrests and media coverage do not remobilize conservatives on social media. *Proceedings of the National Academies of Sciences*. <https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2401239121>
5. Moore*, R. C.[#], **Dahlke*, R.**, Forberg, P. L.[#], & Hancock, J. T.⁺ (2024). The private life of QAnon: A mixed methods investigation of Americans' exposure to QAnon content on the web. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (PACM HCI)*, 8(CSCW2), 1–34. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3687057>
Note · PACM HCI is a peer-reviewed journal (ACM CSCW track).
4. **Dahlke, R.**, & Zhang, Y.[^] (2024). Surviving or thriving political defeat on social media: A temporal analysis of how electoral loss exacerbates the gender gap in political expression. *Journal of Computer-Mediated Communication*, 29(1), zmad051. <https://doi.org/10.1093/jcmc/zmad051>
3. Chen, B.[#], Borah, P.⁺, **Dahlke, R.**, & Lukito, J.[^] (2024). Battle for inbox and bucks: Comparing email fundraising strategies of Donald Trump and Joe Biden in the 2020 U.S. presidential election. *Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media*. <https://doi.org/10.51685/jqd.2024.012>
2. Lukito, J.[^], Greenfield, J.[#], Yang, Y.[^], **Dahlke, R.**, Brown, M. A.[#], Lewis, R.[#], & Chen, B.[#] (2024). Audio-as-data tools: Replicating computational data processing. *Media and Communication*, 12. <https://doi.org/10.17645/mac.7851>
1. Moore*, R. C.[#], **Dahlke*, R.**, & Hancock, J. T.⁺ (2023). Exposure to untrustworthy websites in the 2020 US election. *Nature Human Behaviour*, 1096–1105. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41562-023-01564-2>
Coverage · The New York Times, World Economic Forum, Minnesota Star Tribune, The Daily Beast

Research in Progress

Manuscripts Under Review

Bold = **Dahlke** · * equal or co-first authorship. Co-author status at time of submission: [#] graduate-student or postdoctoral · [‡] undergraduate · [^] untenured junior-faculty · ⁺ tenured-faculty.

4. **Dahlke*, R.**, Moore*, R. C.[^], & Hancock, J. T.⁺ (2026). Exposure to (AI-generated) untrustworthy websites in the 2024 US election. Revise & Resubmit at *Nature Communications*. https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/qtdmg_v1
3. Kwon, H.[#], Jiang, X.[#], & **Dahlke, R.** (2026). Do politicians' strategic facial expressions drive resonant moments on social media? Computational analysis of the 2024 U.S. presidential debate using multimodal large language models. Revise & Resubmit at *International Journal of Communication*.
Award · Top Paper, Information Systems Division of the International Communication Association 2026 Conference
2. **Dahlke, R.**, Lee, A. Y.[#], Stevic, A.[#], Walker-Keleher, G.[‡], Chen, C. Q.-A.[‡], Charity, E.[‡], & Hancock, J. T.⁺ (2026). Replacing smartphones with minimal mobile phones improves college students' trust in news but not news-finds-me perceptions. Under Review.

1. **Dahlke, R., & Hancock, J.⁺** (2025). The public sphere in private spaces: Quantifying political computer-mediated communication in personal messaging. Under Review. <https://osf.io/6cpv8/>

Working Papers & Reports

1. Lukito, J.[^], Brown, M. A.[#], **Dahlke, R.**, Suk, J.[^], Yang, Y.[^], Zhang, Y.[^], Chen, B.[#], Kim, S. J.[^], & Soorholtz, K. (2023). The state of digital media data research, 2023. *Social Science Research Council*. <http://dx.doi.org/10.26153/tsw/46177>

Research Funding & Fellowships

Collaborative Summer Research Initiative	2025
University of Wisconsin–Madison Elections Research Center	\$10,700
Non-Western Countries Expanding Online Trust & Safety Research Grant	2024
Stanford Cyber Policy Center	\$15,000
Graduate Student Researcher	2020–2024
Office of Army Research & DoD Multidisciplinary University Research Initiative (MURI): Multi-Modal Network Information Dynamics Group	
Data Science Scholar	2023
Stanford University Data Science	~\$93,000
Stanford EST (Ethics, Society, and Technology) Research Grant	2023
Stanford University	\$5,000
Stanford PACS (Philanthropy and Civil Society) Research Grant	2023
Stanford University	\$3,000
Knight–Hennessy Scholarship	2020
Stanford University	~\$280,000

Presentations

Invited Talks & Guest Lectures

The Public Sphere in Private Spaces: Political Content and Sources in Personal Messaging	March 2026
Communication and Media Colloquium · University of Iowa	
Exploring Ethical Use of AI and Computational Methods in Organizational Research	October 2025
Organizational Communication Mini Conference 2025 · University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign	
The Consumption of Pink Slime Journalism: Who, What, When, Where, and Why?	March 2025
J395: Language, Media, and Politics · University of Texas at Austin (Virtual)	
Understanding Election Manipulation with Data Science	November 2024
Stanford Democracy Day & Stanford Data Science · Stanford University	
Exposure to Untrustworthy Websites in the 2020 U.S. Presidential Election	November 2023
Communication 124/224: Truth, Trust & Technology · Stanford University	
Untrustworthy Website Exposure and Effects	November 2023
Stanford Democracy Day & Stanford Data Science · Stanford University	
Single Case Research Methodology and Visualization	September 2023
University of Minnesota–Twin Cities	
Exposure to Untrustworthy Websites in the 2020 U.S. Presidential Election	April 2023
Social Technologies Research Group · Cornell Tech	

Teaching

Courses

JOURN / LIS (Information Science) 677 – Concepts and Tools for Data Analysis and Visualization *Spring 2025, Fall 2025, Spring 2026*

University of Wisconsin–Madison · Instructor

JOURN 818 – Computational Approaches for Communication Research

Fall 2025

University of Wisconsin–Madison · Instructor

COMM 124/224 – Truth, Trust & Technology

Spring 2024

Stanford University · Teaching Assistant

COMM 172/272 – Media Psychology

Winter 2023

Stanford University · Teaching Assistant

INTER-LS 250 – Undergraduate Research Experience

Fall 2016, Spring 2017, Fall 2017, Spring 2018

University of Wisconsin–Madison · Teaching Fellow

Professional Development

Madison Teaching and Learning Excellence Fellow

August 2025–May 2026

Center for Teaching, Learning, and Mentoring · University of Wisconsin–Madison

The Discussion Project

August 2025

Wisconsin Center for Education Research · University of Wisconsin–Madison

Wisconsin Idea Seminar

May 2025

Office of the Provost · University of Wisconsin–Madison

Advising

PhD Advising

Yanshu (Sybil) Wang

PhD, Journalism and Mass Communication · Co-Advisor (with Dhavan Shah)

Laila Abbas

PhD, Journalism and Mass Communication · Co-Advisor (with Dhavan Shah)

Haotian (Barry) Zhao

PhD, Journalism and Mass Communication · Advisor

Research MA Advising

Yingqi (Vicky) Huang

MA, Journalism and Mass Communication · Advisor

Directed Study

Yanshu (Sybil) Wang

Spring 2026

Directed Study

Yanshu (Sybil) Wang

Fall 2025

Directed Study

Service

Departmental & University Service

Graduate Committee, School of Journalism and Mass Communication

Member

January 2025–Present

SJMC COWathon (CODing and Writing-athon)

Organizer

October 2025

Professional Service

Computation + Journalism 2026 Symposium, Northwestern University

Program Committee Member · <https://www.cj2026.northwestern.edu/>

May 2026–Present

International Journal of Press + Politics

Data Editor

January 2025–Present

Media & Democracy Data Cooperative (MDDC)

Research Chair, Executive Board Member · <https://mddatacoop.org/>

September 2020–Present

International Communication Association Hackathon

Co-Organizer · <https://www.hackingcommsci.org/>

June 2023–June 2024

Digital Data Conference (D2C)

Co-Organizer · <https://mediaengagement.org/event/digital-data-conference/>

December 2021–April 2022

Peer Review

- AI and Ethics
- Communication Methods and Measures
- Computational Communication Research
- Digital Journalism
- HKS Misinformation Review
- Human Communication Research
- Information Processing and Management
- International Journal of Communication
- International Journal of Public Opinion Research
- Journal of Health Politics, Policy and Law
- Journal of Online Trust and Safety
- Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media
- Journal of Right-Wing Studies
- Mass Communication & Society
- New Media & Society
- Political Communication
- Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (CSCW)
- Science Advances
- Social Science Computer Review
- Virtual Reality

Professional Experience

Data Scientist

Ovative Group

Minneapolis, MN

2018–2020